

Pesly

Financial Intelligence for Vehicle-Based Work — powered by AI-collected evidence

September 2026 · Nairobi, Kenya · Founder: Angela Odhiambo

Revision basis: AI-first data acquisition, driver-independent evidence collection, revised monetization analysis

1. Executive Summary

Pesly is an intelligence layer for Kenya's ride-hailing economy that answers one question with proof: **what did this vehicle really earn, and where did the money go?**

Version 3 changes how Pesly knows the answer. Previous versions relied on drivers and owners self-reporting their numbers. V3 makes **AI the primary data collector**: Pesly gathers evidence directly from the driver's own digital exhaust — platform statements in their email, M-Pesa transaction records, phone notifications, receipts — without depending on anyone typing numbers in. Every figure carries an evidence status. When a driver disagrees with the numbers, the system doesn't ask them to re-enter data — it shows them the underlying receipts.

The core insight: if drivers enter the data, Pesly is only a digitized version of today's problem — one party's word against another's. By having AI independently collect the evidence, Pesly becomes a real solution: machine-gathered, multi-source, verifiable truth.

Revenue model: vehicle owners pay a subscription per vehicle (KSh 300–500/vehicle/month, tiered). Drivers use the core product free, with an optional KSh 100/month "Pesly Plus" premium tier for dispute evidence packs and verified income records. Regulatory position unchanged: Pesly is an intelligence tool, not a transport network company.

2. The Problem — And Why Digitizing It Isn't Enough

Kenya's ride-hailing economy (Uber, Bolt, Little, plus boda bodas) runs on a trust gap between vehicle owners and drivers. The owner sees a car and a weekly handover of cash; the driver sees expenses the owner doesn't believe. Every disagreement is one person's word against another's. Splits are disputed, shortfalls are blamed on "few trips," and relationships decay.

Existing solutions fail because they all make the driver the data-entry clerk:

- **Pen-and-paper logbooks** — self-reported, unverifiable, ignored in disputes.
- **Driver bookkeeping apps** — digital versions of the same self-reported claims. If the driver enters the numbers, the numbers are still just claims. The dispute problem is untouched, merely typed.
- **GPS trackers (Cartrack, TrackAlways)** — telemetry without financial truth; they know where the car went, not what it earned or what it cost to run.

The gap in the market: nobody independently collects the financial evidence. Platform statements, M-Pesa records, and expense receipts already exist on every driver's phone. They're just scattered, unread, and unusable in a dispute. Pesly's job is to read them — automatically.

3. The V3 Solution — AI as the Source of Truth

Pesly's AI evidence engine independently acquires, parses, and reconciles a vehicle's financial reality. The driver does not log their day into Pesly; Pesly reads the record their day already left behind.

3.1 Data sources (in build order)

Source	What it proves	Channel	Status
Platform statements (Uber, Bolt, Little)	Gross fares, trip counts, commissions, incentives per day	Gmail OAuth — app reads statement emails directly	Live (web)
M-Pesa records	Payments sent/received, fuel purchases, bundle costs	Android app reads SMS with explicit user consent; interim: WhatsApp forwarding or photo	Android app — Phase 2
Phone notifications	"30 bob bundles purchased," trip pings, payment alerts — the small leaks nobody records	Android notification-listener access, user-granted	Android app — Phase 2
Receipts & documents	Fuel, parking, servicing, police/county fees	Photo capture with AI OCR	Live (web, fallback)
Phone sensors	Corroborates trips happened (movement patterns)	GPS/accelerometer — used only to corroborate, never as the sole source	Phase 3
Official platform APIs	Direct platform income data	Not available to third parties in Kenya today — monitored	Deferred

3.2 What the AI does with it

- **Extraction:** raw statements, messages, and notifications are parsed into structured records — trips, fares, expenses by category (fuel, data/bundles, parking, maintenance).
- **Evidence grading:** every figure receives a status — Verified (official statement), Supported (M-Pesa record), Reported (manual entry), Estimated (AI inference from patterns), Disputed (contested), Reconciled (cross-confirmed by 2+ sources).
- **Cross-checking:** the engine reconciles machine sources against each other — statement total vs M-Pesa inflows vs notification trail — before a human ever sees a number.
- **Explaining:** AI summarizes what happened in plain language for drivers and owners. It reports facts and flags anomalies as "requires review." It never accuses and never invents.

3.3 The driver's role changes — from clerk to beneficiary

Manual entry remains only as a fallback. The driver's actual interaction with Pesly becomes:

- **Connect once:** link Gmail (and, with the Android app, grant SMS/notification access) with a single consent.
- **Get the record:** see what the AI collected — automatically, daily.
- **Dispute with evidence:** if the driver says "those aren't my numbers," Pesly shows the receipts behind each figure and logs the dispute. Reconciliation happens against evidence, not opinions.

Why this solves the problem nobody else solves: the reconciliation engine no longer compares "what the driver claims" against "what the owner claims." It compares independent machine-gathered sources against each other, and gives both parties the same visible evidence. The argument stops being he-said-she-said and becomes a document on a screen.

4. Reconciliation Engine (V3)

The engine runs in three passes:

- **Pass 1 — Source-to-source:** platform statement vs M-Pesa records vs notification trail, per day. Mismatches create "requires review" items automatically.
- **Pass 2 — Pattern intelligence:** AI learns each vehicle's normal day (typical fuel spend per km, typical trip density, typical bundle spend) and flags statistical outliers — e.g. fuel spend 40% above the vehicle's own baseline.
- **Pass 3 — Human resolution:** disputed items route to both driver and owner with the evidence attached. Resolution marks the figure Reconciled and feeds the baseline for future passes. Neither party edits history — resolutions are appended, versions preserved.

5. Business Model & Monetization Analysis

5.1 Owner subscriptions (core revenue — unchanged)

Tier	Fleet size	Price	Value delivered
Starter	1-3 vehicles	KSh 400/vehicle/ mo	Full reconciliation dashboard, alerts, history
Growth	4-20 vehicles	KSh 350/vehicle/ mo	+ fleet comparison, weekly reports
Fleet	21-100	KSh 300/vehicle/ mo	+ API access, finance exports
Enterprise	100+	Custom	+ integrations, dedicated support

5.2 Should drivers now pay? (New analysis)

Previous versions kept drivers free because they did the work — free entry in exchange for their labor. V3 removes the labor: AI collects everything. The question becomes whether drivers will pay for a record they no longer have to build.

Factor	Assessment
Value without effort	Strongly improved. A driver connects once and receives a verified earnings record automatically. The "free because you work" tradeoff is gone.
Affordability	Typical Nairobi ride-hail drivers gross roughly KSh 60,000-180,000/month; KSh 100 is about two days of data bundles. Price is not the barrier — trust and habit are.
AI operating cost	Parsing a driver's month of statements, messages, and receipts costs Pesly an estimated KSh 20-60 in AI processing. A KSh 100 fee covers it with margin; KSh 50 is marginal.
Collection cost	M-Pesa business fees on a KSh 100 paybill collection are now minimal (Safaricom's 2026 tariff cuts; sub-KSh-200 rates near zero). Collection friction is manageable.
Adoption risk	The critical constraint. The two-sided model needs driver volume to make owner subscriptions valuable. A mandatory driver fee throttles data supply exactly when network effects matter most. Drivers burned by "typing job" scams also distrust anything that asks for money upfront.
Churn cascade	If a driver stops paying, their vehicle goes dark — and the paying owner loses visibility. Mandatory driver fees let driver churn damage owner revenue.

Recommendation: hybrid — free core, paid premium.

Core (free forever): account connection, automatic sync, daily earnings record, evidence view, dispute submission. This keeps driver adoption frictionless and data supply strong.

Pesly Plus (KSh 100/month): downloadable dispute evidence pack (PDF receipts organized for an owner confrontation or tribunal), verified income certificate (usable for loan and insurance applications), extended 12-month history, priority dispute resolution. At 5–10% conversion of active drivers, Plus becomes a high-margin second revenue line without ever gating the core.

KSh 50 is rejected: too low to signal premium value, marginal after AI costs, and it still triggers the same payment friction as KSh 100. If a driver will pay anything, they will pay 100.

6. Market & Competition (unchanged, repositioned)

Player	What they do	Why Pesly differs
RiderPal	Driver bookkeeping app, driver-paid	Self-reported claims; no reconciliation, no owner product. Pesly: AI-gathered evidence, both sides of the trust gap.
Cartrack / TrackAlways	GPS telematics for fleets	Location data without financial truth. No driver product, no reconciliation.
Onde	Dispatch software for operators	Serves companies launching their own ride-hailing, not individual owners and drivers.
Argyle / Moove	Income data access (US/ Nigeria)	Single-platform, API-based income verification. Moove's Nigeria model broke when Uber exited — proof that multi-source, evidence-first design is the durable architecture.

Market size (top-down): Kenya has roughly 40,000+ ride-hailing vehicles and several hundred thousand boda bodas. Every vehicle has an owner and a driver in a trust relationship. At a conservative 1% penetration of ride-hailing vehicles (400 vehicles) with an average owner subscription of KSh 350/vehicle/month, Pesly clears KSh 1.7M in annual recurring revenue before Plus conversions and boda expansion.

7. Product Architecture & Current Build State

- **Live now (web app):** v2 data model (TripLog, FuelLog, Agreement, PrivacyGrant, Alert with evidence statuses), reconciliation display, agreement versioning engine, privacy center with driver-controlled grants, Gmail OAuth auto-sync for platform statements, AI smart-capture fallback (paste/photo/shorthand), emerald dark-mode design system.
- **Next web pass:** automated reconciliation engine (auto-flagging), demo data seed, owner onboarding & subscription screens, light/dark mode toggle (white-green light mode, emerald dark mode), logo on every page.
- **Phase 2 — Android app:** M-Pesa SMS reading and notification-listener capture with explicit user consent screens. This unlocks the "reads even the 30-bob bundle purchase" capability that a web app cannot physically access.
- **Phase 3 — WhatsApp channel:** drivers send photos/short texts to the Pesly WhatsApp number; AI parses them into their account without opening the app.

Note on honesty in product design: the web app will never pretend to read SMS or notifications. Those screens state plainly that automatic M-Pesa/notification sync arrives with the Android app. Trust is the product; faking capabilities destroys it.

8. Regulatory Position

Pesly is a financial intelligence and record-keeping tool. It is not a transport network company, does not dispatch, match, or carry passengers, and takes no commission from trips — so it does not trigger TNC licensing. Data access is consent-based per source (Gmail OAuth scope-limited to statements; Android SMS/notification permissions user-granted and revocable in-app at any time). Drivers control access grants beyond the owner's default boundary. Registration as a legal entity is deferred until a specific grant program (e.g. MEST Africa Challenge) requires it.

9. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Platforms change statement email formats	Parser built with AI extraction (pattern-tolerant), not brittle regex; monitoring alerts on parse failures.
Drivers decline to connect Gmail	Web MVP offers photo/paste fallback; the value visible in the free tier must be enough to justify one consent tap.
Notification/SMS access seen as surveillance	Grant screens show exactly what is read, what is never read (personal chats), one-tap revoke, visible audit trail. The Privacy Center is a feature, not fine print.
Owner-driver disputes escalate despite evidence	Dispute pack exports; neutral "requires review" language throughout; resolution history preserved for third parties (SACCOs, tribunals, lenders).
AI parsing errors damage trust	Every parsed figure is reviewable and disputable by the driver before it becomes Reconciled; estimates are always labeled as estimates.

10. Roadmap

When	Milestone
Sept 2026	Web MVP complete: Gmail sync, automated reconciliation, onboarding, dual-mode design; demo data seeded; app published live
Oct-Dec 2026	Pilot: 3-5 vehicles in Nairobi (owner + driver pairs); measure sync reliability, dispute resolution rate; first paying owners
Q1 2027	Android app beta: M-Pesa SMS + notification capture; Pesly Plus launch at KSh 100/month
Q2 2027	WhatsApp capture channel; boda boda expansion; grant applications (MEST Africa Challenge)

The one-line pitch for this version:

Pesly reads the receipts so nobody has to trust anybody. Owners finally see what the vehicle really earned; drivers finally hold proof of what it really cost — and the argument ends at the evidence.

Pesly Business Plan v3 · September 2026 · Supersedes v2 (pesly-business-plan-v2.pdf) · Changes: AI-first evidence acquisition, driver-role redefinition, driver monetization analysis (hybrid free-core/Plus model), Android notification-capture roadmap, light/dark dual-mode design direction.